

The Four Pillars at Home

Identity, self-compassion, forgiveness, and grace — the ground every healthy relationship stands on.

PILLAR ONE

Identity

Who a child comes to believe they are — shaped by what we notice out loud.

TRY THIS AT HOME: “CATCH THEM BEING”

Once a day, name one **true thing you saw them be**, not just what they achieved. Praise the person, not only the grade.

Say: *“I noticed how patient you were with your brother today.”*

PILLAR TWO

Self-Compassion

How a child learns to speak to themselves when things go wrong.

TRY THIS AT HOME: “FLIP THE CRITIC”

When the harsh voice shows up, help them **talk to themselves like a friend**. Model it on your own slip-ups, out loud.

They say “I’m so stupid.” → *“You made a mistake — that’s being human. What can you learn?”*

PILLAR THREE

Forgiveness

Moving past mistakes to make room for growth — theirs and yours.

TRY THIS AT HOME: “THE REDO”

Walk through the four repair steps together: **own it · name the impact · make it right · reset**. Share a mistake of your own first.

Try a “mistake of the week” at dinner. You go first. *It makes repair normal, not scary.*

PILLAR FOUR

Grace

Meeting a child with understanding rather than only judgment.

TRY THIS AT HOME: “CONNECTION BEFORE CORRECTION”

Before you correct, take **one calm breath** and ask **one kind question**. Your calm is the intervention.

Say: *“Looks like a rough one. Tell me what happened.”*